

Evidential Transference in Quechua-Spanish Bilingual Speakers

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Overview

- ★ **The purpose of this research is to document the evidential system in Quechua used in the Ancash region of Perú by Quechua–Spanish bilinguals.**
- ★ **Specifically, this research aims to learn more about persistence of the evidential system in Spanish contact situations.**

The Ancash Department

- **Ancash Quechua or Huaylas Quechua is defined as Quechua I (Torero 1964)**
- **Spoken by 170,000 people (Menacho 2005).**



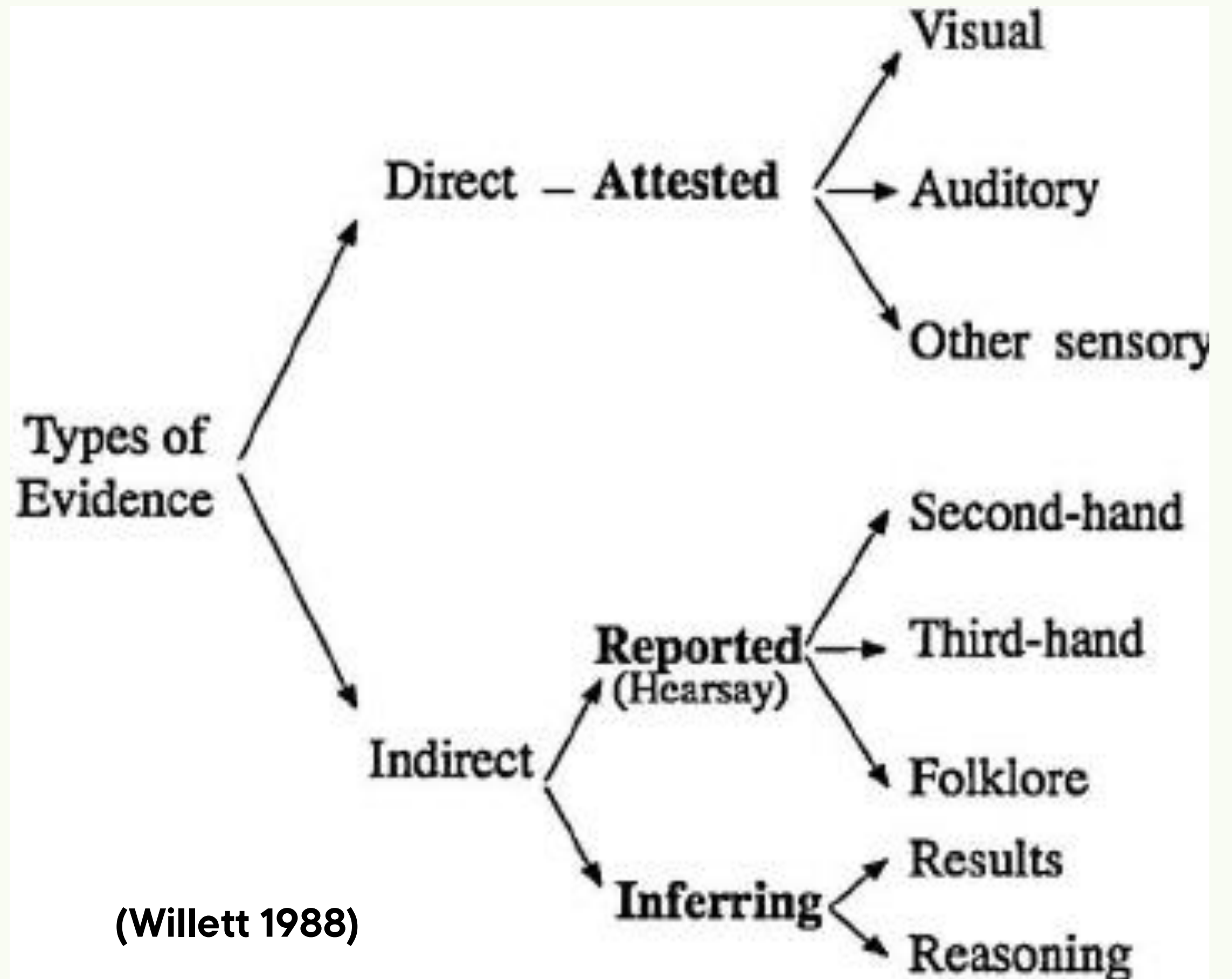
What’s an evidential?

Theory of Evidential Suffixes as Information Source

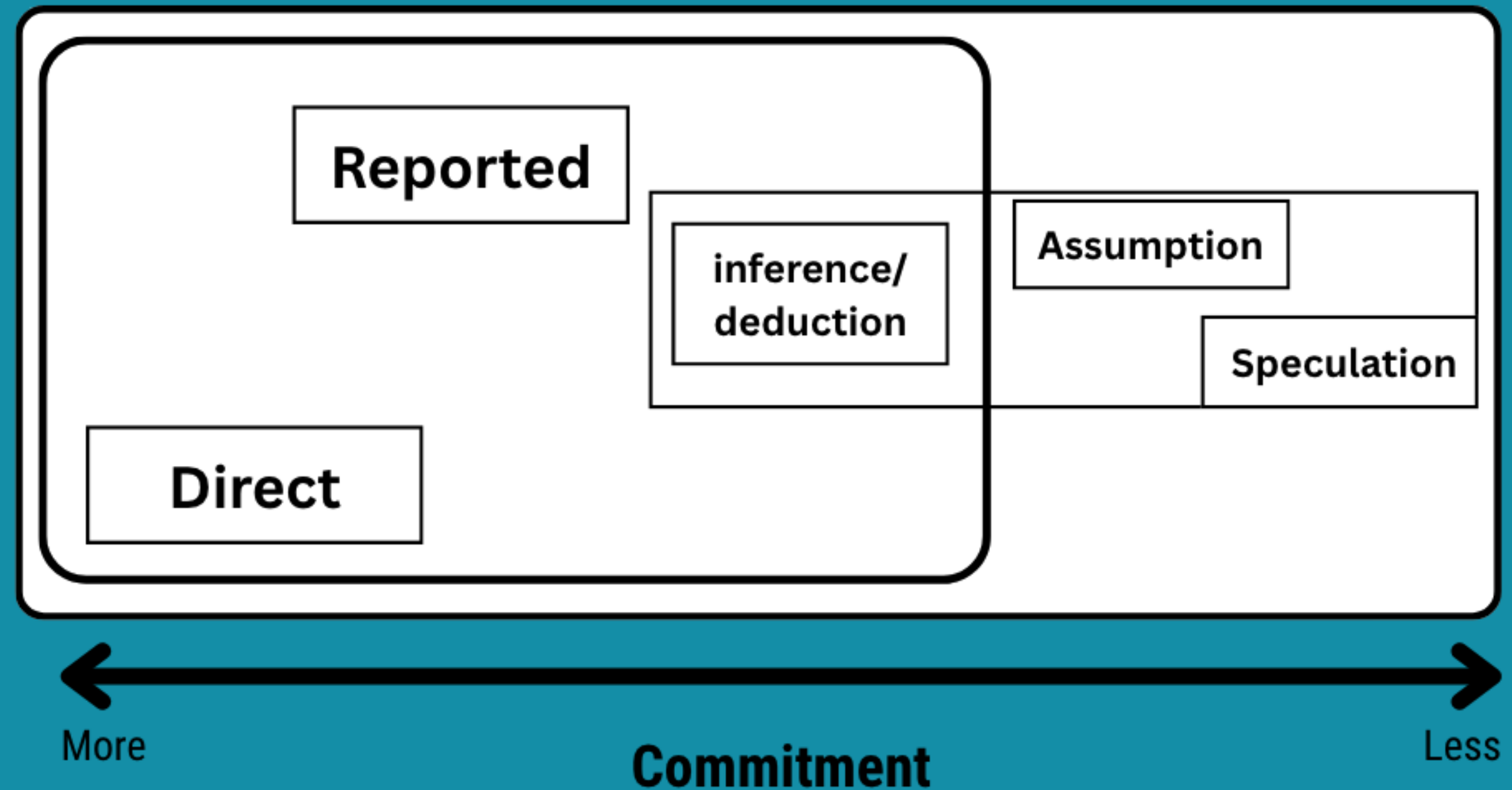
- Quechua has 3 evidential systems

(Aikhenvald 2012)	Directly Witnessed	Reported	Deduced
Vowel	-m	-sh	-chá
Consonant	-mi	-shi	-chí

Evidential Systems as Information Source:



Evidential Systems as Speaker Commitment to likelihood Judgements



(Palmer 1999:25)

Syntax, Word Order and Basic Clause Structure

SOV

(1). Achiquee

Achiquee (name)

Achiquee

Achiquee

tara-rqa-n

live-PST-



3SG

- Word order is SOV but Subject dropping is frequent.

- The clause structure of Quechua involves TAM markers that are attached to the end of Verb Stems.

Methodology

Pilot Study:

- A single native speaker was asked to related the story of the Achiquee, a well-known children's story in the Ancash region.
- Use of the evidential system was compared to recorded accounts from Ancash in the 1970s (Pantoja 1974).

- **74-Year-old**
- **Female**
- **Native Spanish**
Quechua
Bilingual
Speaker



How Do Evidential Systems Persist in Contact Situations?

A reduction of the evidential system is said to be unlikely, as evidential are a key feature in the grammatical structure of Quechua. (Aikhenvald 2012, Escobar 2023). Still, some reduction in evidential usage among bilingual populations (Manley 2007). In this presentation, it is argued that the semantic form of the evidential persists even if no overt evidential marking is present.

Witnessed:

(Pantoja 1974:7)

(2). Tsay ushari-pti-ña-m awku-rqa-a knobentu sentenaryu-man
DEM finish-SUBIS-PERF-DIR go-PST-1SG convent Centenario-ALL

‘When that finished, I went to the convent in Centenario.’

“Cuando eso terminó, fui al convento en Centenario.” (Pantoja 1974:43)

Reportative:

(Pantoja 1974:6)

(3).

Tsay	topash-qan	hunaq	sella-ma- <u>sh</u>	fyesta	ka-kunaq	tsaychaw
DEM	day-GEN	when	gather-PST. <u>REP</u>	party	be-PL.REP	there.LOC

‘That day, when they met, they say that they had a party there’

(“Ese día cuando se reunieron, dicen que hubo una gran fiesta allí.”)

(Pantoja 1974:7)

Reportative #2:

(Pantoja 1974:18)

(4).

Willya-ku-ya-n tsay mayor nuna-kuna shumaq-shi takshalla-pis
tell-REFL-PROG-3SG DEM elder person-PL beautiful-REP chapel-DIM-ADD

‘The elders tell that that chapel, even though small, was beautiful.’

(“Personas de edad cuentan que esa capilla, aunque pequeña, era bonita..”)
(Pantoja 1974:19)

Bilingual Speakers *without* Evidentials

(5).

Achiquee unay-n tiempos ka-shqan.

Achiquee past-GEN time.PL be-PST.PTCP.

Nin tiempos...

Achiquee en tiempos creen en ampaq.

Say.3SG.PRS. Those time.PL... Achiquee in time.PL believe.3PL.PRS in escape.

“Achiquee existed in old times. In those times... Achiquee, in those times, they believed in escape.”



Bilingual Speakers *with* Evidentials

(6).

Achiquee ka-naq rumi-ta para-rqa-n. chunki-sh nina runtu kapti-sqa-naq.
Achiquee be-AGT stone-ACC rain-PST.3SG ten-REP fire egg possess-PST.PTCP-AGT

runkhi hallpa-qa ka-n-mi
rough earth.FOC be-3SG-DIR

*“Achiquee, one who was, threw a stone ten times, they say, fire, eggs, and what was possessed.
The rough (coarse) earth exists.”*



Summary: Evidential markers persist among bilingual speakers

While not overt, the use of evidential markers remains a core aspect of Quechua's aspectual system.

The emergence of evidential markers to distinguish information source in example (6) suggests, not only a contrastive use, but provides evidence for their latent existence as in (7).

Analysis and Conclusion

**Evidential systems persist
in Bilingual speakers
despite Spanish contact.**

**The evidence provided
demonstrates that evidential
markers remain mandatory.**

**While not overtly expressed, the
evidential system remains an
essential part of the semantic
construction of Quechua.**

“Truth does not, and never has, come unadorned. It must appear in its proper clothing or it is not acknowledged, which is a way of saying that the “truth” is a kind of cultural prejudice. Each culture conceives of it as being most authentically expressed in certain symbolic forms that another culture may regard as trivial or irrelevant”

(Postman 1985:30)

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Thank you!

For questions, email you can
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